

WOODLAND DREAMS I-CORD SUSPENDERS

LME BABY COLLECTION - WOODLAND DREAMS

A pair of simple, adjustable i-cord suspenders, that cross at the back and fasten at the front with small wooden buttons. The suspenders are the signature piece of the collection: they can be worn over trousers, shorts, bloomers or the basisbody, so one single pair can follow the child through several different outfits. Seven sizes, from 0-1 to 18-24 months.

By Renate Dahl

Little Montessori Explorers

lmexplorers.com



TIP: I-cord does not need an exact gauge to work, but read through the whole pattern and the size chart on page 4 before you start, so you choose the right size from the beginning.

ABOUT THE I-CORD SUSPENDERS

THE SIGNATURE PIECE OF THE COLLECTION

If there is one piece in Woodland Dreams worth a little extra love, it is this one. The i-cord suspenders are the piece that makes the whole collection truly modular. Sew four small wooden buttons onto a pair of bloomers, a pair of shorts or the basisbody itself, and the suspenders can move from garment to garment all season long. One pair of suspenders, many outfits.

A SIMPLE TECHNIQUE, A BEAUTIFUL RESULT

I-cord is one of the simplest techniques in knitting, a narrow, round cord knitted on just a few stitches. That is exactly why it is perfect for suspenders. It is strong, stretchy enough to move with the child, and quick to knit, even if you have never tried the technique before.

USE ACROSS DIFFERENT GARMENTS

The suspenders are not sewn to any particular garment. Attach them with wooden buttons to a pair of bloomers one day, switch to shorts the next, or wear them right over the basisbody on a cool walk outside. The idea is a small investment that outlasts any single garment.

MATERIALS

YARN

Sandnes Garn Alpakka (100% alpaca), or an equivalent yarn with the same gauge. As the suspenders are an accessory, choose one of the collection's contrast colours for the i-cord itself, for example sage, dusty rose, butter yellow, soft blue, olive or terracotta, for a lovely contrast to the body's calm, neutral colours (cream, linen, sand, oatmeal or beige).

YARN REQUIREMENTS

I-cord uses very little yarn. One 50 g ball of Sandnes Garn Alpakka is more than enough for both suspenders, in any of the seven sizes, even with a few extra centimetres for a gauge swatch and any mistakes.

NEEDLES AND NOTIONS

Two 4 mm double-pointed needles (or a short 4 mm circular needle used as a DPN), for the i-cord itself. A 3 mm crochet hook for crocheting the buttonhole loops. Four small, round wooden buttons, sewn onto the garment the suspenders will attach to, not onto the suspenders themselves. A tapestry needle for weaving in ends, and ideally a tape measure to check the strap length as you go.

ABOUT GAUGE AND THE SWATCH

I-cord does not need a precise gauge to fit correctly. The cord will simply end up a little thicker or thinner than expected. The gauge below (see page 5) is still used in this pattern to calculate roughly how many rounds match the correct length for your size, and to keep the suspenders consistent with the rest of the collection. Knit a small gauge swatch in stockinette anyway if you like, and measure your actual strap length as you go with a tape measure rather than blindly counting rounds.

SIZE CHART

The suspenders are sized based on the body's measurements for each size, see Woodland Dreams Basisbody. Choose the same size as the body, or the garment the suspenders will attach to.

Size	Chest width (ref.)	Body length (ref.)	Strap length
0-1 mnd	46.4 cm	25 cm	34.0 cm
1-3 mnd	49.1 cm	27 cm	36.4 cm
3-6 mnd	51.8 cm	30 cm	40.0 cm
6-9 mnd	54.5 cm	33 cm	43.6 cm
9-12 mnd	57.3 cm	36 cm	47.2 cm
12-18 mnd	60.0 cm	39 cm	50.8 cm
18-24 mnd	62.7 cm	42 cm	54.4 cm

Chest width and body length are taken from Woodland Dreams Basisbody, and are given here only as a reference for choosing the right size. Strap length is the suspenders' own finished length, from tip to tip, before the strap is folded over the shoulder.

GAUGE AND DIFFICULTY LEVEL

GAUGE

22 stitches and 30 rounds in stockinette stitch = 10 x 10 cm, on 4 mm needles, the same gauge as the rest of the Woodland Dreams collection. In this pattern the gauge is used to calculate an approximate number of rounds for each strap length (see the table on page 8), not to control the i-cord technique itself, which works fine at most gauges.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

Easy. I-cord is one of the simplest techniques in knitting: you only need to be able to knit, and slide the stitches back without turning the work. This pattern makes a great first i-cord project, even if you are still fairly new to knitting.

ABBREVIATIONS

Norwegian knitting and crochet terms with the English terms alongside.

Norwegian	English	Meaning
r	K	rett
m	st(s)	maske(r)
o	rnd	omgang
legg opp	CO	legg opp masker
fell av	BO	fell av / bind off
strømpepinne	DPN	strømpepinne (dobbeltpiss)
rundpinne	circular needle	rundpinne
maskemarkør	st marker	maskemarkør
heklenål	crochet hook	heklenål
luftmaske / lm	chain / ch	luftmaske i hekling
kjedemaske	slip stitch / sl st	kjedemaske i hekling
i-cord	i-cord	små, rund strikkesnor på strømpepinne

TIPS

- Knit both suspenders to the same length, count your rounds or measure with a tape measure for each, so they end up the same length.
- Knit the i-cord loosely, a too-tight i-cord becomes stiff and less comfortable against the skin.
- Place a small scrap-yarn marker every 10th round as you knit, it makes it easier to keep track of how far you have come.

HOW TO KNIT I-CORD

I-cord is a narrow, round knitted cord worked on double-pointed needles, without knitting in the round the usual way. The technique is simple, but can feel a little unfamiliar the first time, so here it is explained step by step.

- 1 Cast on 3 stitches onto a 4 mm double-pointed needle.
- 2 Knit all 3 stitches.
- 3 Do NOT turn the work. Slide the stitches to the opposite end of the needle, the end you just knitted from.
- 4 Pull the yarn firmly across the back of the work, from left to right, and knit the 3 stitches again.
- 5 Repeat steps 3 and 4 over and over. After a few rounds the yarn pulls itself into a tight, round cord at the back, with no visible seam.
- 6 Continue until the strap length in the table on page 8 is reached for your size. Measure with a tape measure as you go if you like.



TIP: The first couple of centimetres look a little messy. That is completely normal: the cord tightens itself into a neat, round tube as you keep knitting.

PART 1: KNIT THE TWO STRAPS

Knit two identical suspenders, each worked as one long i-cord. The strap length is calculated from the body's body length for each size, so the strap is long enough to run from the front waistband, over the shoulder, cross at the back and down to the opposite side at the back waistband.

The strap length is calculated with this simple formula: $2 \times (0.6 \times \text{the body's body length}) + 4 \text{ cm}$. The factor 0.6 is an estimate of the waist-to-shoulder distance, both at the front and the back, and the extra 4 cm covers the crossing at the back plus a little ease for movement. The number is doubled because the strap runs both up the front and down the back, to the opposite side.

Size	Body length (ref.)	Strap length	I-cord rounds (approx.)
0-1 mnd	25 cm	34.0 cm	102
1-3 mnd	27 cm	36.4 cm	109
3-6 mnd	30 cm	40.0 cm	120
6-9 mnd	33 cm	43.6 cm	131
9-12 mnd	36 cm	47.2 cm	142
12-18 mnd	39 cm	50.8 cm	152
18-24 mnd	42 cm	54.4 cm	163

The round count is an approximate reference calculated from the gauge on page 5. I-cord length can vary a little from knitter to knitter, always measure the strap length in the cm column for your size, do not just count rounds.

- 1 Cast on 3 stitches onto a 4 mm double-pointed needle.
- 2 Work i-cord (see page 7) until the strap length in the table above is reached for your size.
- 3 Cut the yarn leaving a tail of approx. 15 cm. Thread the tail through the 3 remaining stitches with a tapestry needle, and pull tight.
- 4 Knit the second strap exactly the same way, to the same length.

PART 2: BUTTONHOLE LOOPS AND ADJUSTABILITY

At each end of both straps, three small loops are crocheted, spaced a little apart, so the strap length can be adjusted without any reknitting.

- 1 With a 3 mm crochet hook and a loose end of yarn from the i-cord (or new yarn attached at the end), crochet a chain of approx. 5-6 chain stitches.
- 2 Fasten the chain to the end of the i-cord with a slip stitch, so it forms a small loop, large enough to fit a wooden button through.
- 3 Crochet two more loops on the same end, spaced approx. 1.5 cm apart, along the last 3 cm of the strap.
- 4 Repeat on all four ends of the two straps: 2 straps x 2 ends = 4 ends, 3 loops per end, 12 loops in total.

HOW TO ADJUST THE LENGTH

The three loops at each end give three lengths to choose between. Use the outermost loop, at the very tip, for the longest possible length, and one of the loops further in for a shorter, snugger fit. This way the suspenders can be adjusted as the child grows, or to suit whichever garment they are attached to, without any reknitting.

HOW THE SUSPENDERS CROSS AT THE BACK

The suspenders are designed to cross in an X at the back, just like classic braces. Attach the left strap to the left side at the front, bring it up over the left shoulder, let it cross over the back and attach it to the right side at the back waistband. Do the opposite with the other strap: attach it to the right side at the front, over the right shoulder, crossing down to the left side at the back.

STYLING TIP

If you prefer a quieter look, the suspenders can just as easily be attached straight down without crossing. They work fine either way. The crossing at the back is what gives the classic, slightly old-fashioned suspender look the collection is inspired by.

FINISHING

- 1 Weave in all loose ends securely on the wrong side of each loop and strap end, and trim them short.
- 2 Sew the four wooden buttons onto the garment the suspenders will be used with, bloomers, shorts or the basisbody, in positions that suit the crossing described on the previous page.
- 3 Try the suspenders on the child or against the garment before sewing the buttons on fully, and adjust the button positions if needed.
- 4 Lightly steam-block the suspenders if you like, to even out the i-cord.
- 5 Finally, check that every loop and button is securely attached, and that no loose threads can come undone.

SAFETY AND CARE

SAFETY

- Small wooden buttons are a choking hazard. Sew them on with double thread, several times through each hole, and check them regularly, especially after washing.
- Never leave a child alone and unsupervised in the suspenders, whether playing, in a pram or in bed, especially the first few times they are worn.
- Before every wear, check that no loop, strap or loose thread is long or loose enough to wrap around the child's neck. Remove the suspenders completely before the child is put down to sleep.
- Tighten all buttons and loops securely, so a strap cannot come loose and hang freely while the child is moving around.
- All measurements and lengths in this pattern are calculated for a roomy, comfortable fit, not a tight safety fit. Always follow current safety recommendations for children's clothing and accessories with cords or straps.

CARE INSTRUCTIONS

Hand wash gently in lukewarm water with wool wash, or machine wash on a wool cycle at 30 degrees, together with the rest of the garment they are attached to. Press out the water, ease the i-cord straight, and dry lying flat on a towel.

ALL DONE!

Congratulations, your suspenders are finished! They are made to be paired with several different garments in the Woodland Dreams collection, and to follow the child from one outfit to the next.

THE REST OF THE COLLECTION

- Basisbody, the foundation of the collection, a top-down raglan body in stockinette stitch.
- Lace collar, a loose collar that fastens at the back.
- Ruffle collar, the same fastening, a little more romantic.
- Peter Pan collar, a classic rounded collar.
- Bib, tied with an i-cord or a button.
- Short vest, with wooden buttons at the front, worn over the body.
- Woodland Fluffy Skirt, a crocheted skirt made to match the body.

COPYRIGHT

(c) Renate Dahl, Little Montessori Explorers. This pattern is a fully original LME design. You are welcome to sell finished garments you make from this pattern, on a small personal scale, provided the finished product is checked against current safety requirements. The pattern itself, its text and images, may not be shared, copied or resold.

By Renate Dahl · Little Montessori Explorers · lmexplorers.com